Amy Kim

kimamy@princeton.edu | amykimecon.com | 617-800-5343

Placement Director	Gianluca Violante	violante@princeton.edu	609-258-4003
Graduate Administrator	Laura Hedden	lhedden@princeton.edu	609-258-4006

EDUCATION

Princeton University, Princeton **2021—present**
Ph.D. Candidate, Economics

References

Professor Ilyana Kuziemko	Professor Leah Boustan	Professor David Lee
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
Princeton University	Yale University	Princeton University
kuziemko@princeton.edu	leah.boustan@yale.edu	davidlee@princeton.edu

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge **2017– 2021**
B.S. Computer Science & Mathematics; Economics

FIELDS

Labor Economics, Migration, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

"International Students and the U.S. Skilled Workforce: Evidence from Optional Practical Training"

International graduates of U.S. universities increasingly remain to work after graduation through Optional Practical Training (OPT). This paper asks whether this work authorization adds to U.S. employment or replaces work that would have occurred anyway, either by the same graduates under another status or by other workers at the same employers. I answer this question using new data that link administrative records on U.S. international students to LinkedIn career histories, and leveraging variation in eligibility for a two-year extension to OPT. Graduates who become eligible for a longer period spend about seven more months working on OPT over the three years after graduation, but their U.S. employment rises by only about five: the remaining months replace work they would have done anyway, often while enrolled in another degree, and the gain fades once the authorization expires. Employers with greater access to eligible graduates hire 29% more OPT workers and sponsor more of them for longer-term work visas, without reducing hiring through other channels. Together, the results show that post-graduation work authorization expands the U.S. skilled workforce: most of the work it enables would not otherwise have occurred, and employers absorb these graduates without displacing other workers.

PUBLICATIONS

"The Effects of Prohibiting Marriage Bars: The Case of U.S. Teachers" with Carolyn Tsao, *The Journal of Economic History* [forthcoming].

- Winner of the 2024 IPUMS USA Research Award

WORKING PAPERS

"Evaluating the Consequences of High Migration Costs: Evidence from the 1885 Chinese Head Tax"

"Staying Power: The Individual Effects of the H-1B Visa Lottery"

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Presentations and Seminars

2026 Princeton University, Midwestern Economics Association Annual Conference
2025 Migrations and Organizations Ph.D. Consortium
2024 McMaster University

Refereeing

American Economic Journal: Applied Microeconomics, Journal of Economic History

TEACHING

Quantitative Analysis for Policymakers (SPI 507A), Princeton **Fall 2024**

MAJOR HONORS, AWARDS & GRANTS

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship **2021– 2026**
IPUMS USA Award for Best Student Research **2024**
Program for Research on Inequality Grant Recipient **2023**
Louis A. Simpson *60 P90 Graduate Fellowship **2022**
Phi Beta Kappa Society Inductee **2021**

OTHER

Native Speaker of English; **Heritage Speaker of** Korean; **Intermediate** French
Citizen of Canada and USA